HOORVIA - USDA MEAT TEMPERATURES: PRINTABLE SAFE CHART

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet · A4 Printable

Kitchen & Cooking · Sheet #1

Meat / Protein Type	Minimum Safe Internal Temp (USDA)	Resting Time Required	Culinary / Chef Target Temp	Temperature Probe Placement
Poultry (Chicken & Turkey Whole or Ground)	165°F (73.9°C)	None required (5 mins recommended)	165°F (Breast) / 175°F (Thighs/Dark Meat)	Thickest part of breast or thigh, avoiding bone
Ground Meats (Beef, Pork, Lamb, Veal)	160°F (71.1°C)	None required	160°F (No pink center)	Center of thickest patty or meatloaf
Fresh Beef, Veal, Lamb (Steaks, Chops)	145°F (62.8°C)	3 Minutes rest on warm board	130°F-135°F (Medium-Rare) / 145°F (Medium)	Center of steak horizontally away from fat or bone
Fresh Pork (Chops, Roasts, Loin)	145°F (62.8°C)	3 Minutes rest on warm board	145°F (Slight blush pink in center)	Thickest portion away from bone
Fish & Fin Shellfish	145°F (62.8°C)	None required	125°F-135°F (Salmon flakes easily with fork)	Thickest section of fillet
Leftovers & Casseroles	165°F (73.9°C)	2 Minutes rest	165°F steaming hot throughout	Center of casserole dish
Ground Poultry (Chicken / Turkey)	165°F (73.9°C)	None required	165°F (No pink center)	Center of thickest patty
Whole Turkey	165°F (73.9°C)	20 Minutes rest	165°F (Breast) / 175°F (Thigh)	Thickest part of thigh, avoiding bone
Ham (Fresh, Uncooked)	145°F (62.8°C)	3 Minutes rest	145°F	Thickest portion away from bone
Ham (Pre-cooked)	140°F (60°C)	None required	140°F	Center of ham
Shrimp & Shellfish	145°F (62.8°C)	None required	145°F (Opaque, firm)	Thickest part
Duck Breast	165°F (73.9°C)	3 Minutes rest	135°F (Medium-rare, chef)	Thickest part, away from bone

PRO TIP: Trust the thermometer, not the color: Color lies: pink pork can be safe at 145°F and brown ground beef can be undercooked. Only the internal temperature tells the truth.